



Figure 1: Default desktop



Figure 2: First-boot script

experience, I never had a single crash on any of my laptops. After using Crunchbang, my feeling about it tends towards evangelism; it is addictive because of its minimalism and simplicity.

Verdict

The pros:

- Great set of default applications.
- Great hardware compatibility out-of-the-box.
- Very light on system resources.

The cons:

- No eye-candy.
- No icons on the desktop (GNOME users will find this annoying).
- No email client by default (although IceDove, the unbranded version of Mozilla Thunderbird can be quickly installed from Debian repos using the Synaptic package manager).

Crunchbang is a distro for people who want something in between the Xubuntu and a Debian install with an Openbox environment. If you are a minimalist who is addicted to Debian, then this is the distro of choice for you.



Note: Crunchbang may take about 10 minutes for the first two to three boots, but after that, it is under two minutes always.

Installation on the Intel Apple Mac (dual-boot with OS X)

Here are the steps:

1. Click the *diskutility.app* icon in the utilities folder in *Applications* and resize your OS X partition according to your needs. Warning: just resize the partition—do not create a new partition, else you will lose all data on your OS X partition. Leave the hard disk space other than your



Figure 3: Refit boot sequence screen

OS X partition as 'free space'.

2. Download and install '*refit.dmg*' from www.refit.sourceforge.net on your internal hard drive.
3. Reboot thrice. This is required as the MBR table of the apple EFI interface is stored in the R.O.M chips and it takes three attempts to successfully rewrite data to the P.R.O.M.



Note: Don't panic if, when you select your Linux partition, you see a white screen with Tux sitting in the centre—this is supposed to happen. This screen may seem to be 'stuck', but it is a front-end for the Linux kernel's pre-bootstrapping processes, so don't worry; let it take its time.

4. Install Crunchbang; when the disk partitioning options come up, click the *Use Largest Free Space Available* and then install the system. Ensure you select the GRUB (bootloader) destination as the */boot* partition, and NOT the MBR, else your Mac will be unbootable, and will require a rescue boot with the Mac OS X Install DVD.
5. While rebooting, you will see the '*Refit*' boot sequence screen. From it, select the partition utility, which is the second icon from the left in the second row of small icons. It will suggest synchronising the boot sequence list or the *gpt* partition table; press 'y' and then <Return> and if all goes well, you will be redirected to the refit screen. You will now be able to boot into your new Crunchbang install on your Mac—just select the Linux partitions icon. 

Links

Official Crunchbang forums: www.crunchbang.org/forum

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